



TANZANIA

Capital city: Dodoma**Area:** 364,898 sq miles (945,087 sq km)**Population:** 37,000,000**Official languages:** Kiswahili, English**Major religions:**

Traditional beliefs 30%, Christian 33%, Muslim 33%, other 4%

Government: Multiparty democracy**Currency:** Tanzanian shilling**Adult literacy rate:** 77%**Life expectancy:** 43 years**People per doctor:** 25,000**Televisions:** 21 per 1,000 people

DAR ES SALAAM

Although Tanzania's capital is now the inland city of Dodoma, the old capital, Dar es Salaam, remains the country's biggest city and port. It is also the end of the TanZam railroad, which carries goods from land-locked Zambia to the sea.



The name Dar es Salaam means "Haven of Peace." The city is still fairly small, with few high-rise buildings and many low, red-tiled roofs.



TANZANIAN VILLAGES

The country's population used to be scattered in small villages. Then, in 1970, the government started a program to resettle the population in larger villages of about 250 households. By grouping people together in this way, it is easier and more economic to provide schools, water, and other services, and to distribute fertilizers and seeds. Today, 66 percent of Tanzanians live in villages in the countryside.

TANZANIA

TANZANIA WAS CREATED in 1964, when the mainland country of Tanganyika and the island of Zanzibar united. For its first 21 years Tanzania had a socialist government that tried to encourage people to work together on programs such as state-run plantations. Although it is now expanding its range of exports, Tanzania is much poorer than neighboring Kenya, and only about one third of people live in towns and cities. About 120 different peoples live here, most of whom speak Kiswahili, a language developed as a means of communication between Africans and foreign traders.



OLDUVAI GORGE

The steep sides of Olduvai Gorge in northern Tanzania were carved out of the flat Serengeti Plain by the flow of water over millions of years. Here, archeologists have unearthed fossils of the earliest humans, dating back 2 million years. Yet more ancient footprints of humanlike creatures have been discovered, too, left by two adults and a child walking across the still-soft lava that formed the plain 3.5 million years ago.

Making sisal fiber



The outer leaves of the sisal plant are cut off close to the stalk when they reach their full length.

The sisal fiber is usually obtained by crushing the leaves between rollers. The pulp is removed, leaving strands of white fiber over 3 ft (1 m) long.



The strands of fiber are washed and then hung out to dry.

SISAL

One of Tanzania's main crops is sisal, a plant with leaves that are used to make rope and twine, and also mats, brushes, hats, and baskets. Sisal ropes are particularly useful on board ships since they do not rot in seawater. However, Tanzania's sisal trade is now under threat because many products made with sisal in the past can now be made with synthetic substitutes.



String made from sisal



The buildings and style of clothes reflect Zanzibar's continuing Arabic flavor.

ZANZIBAR

Off Tanzania's coast lies the island of Zanzibar. In the 18th and 19th centuries, the port of Zanzibar, on the island's western side, was used as an Arab trading post. African slaves passed through here, en route to the Arab world. The island's main crop, cloves, was also shipped out of the port. The clove tree was only introduced to the island in 1818, but today Zanzibar is the world's third largest producer.

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